

Contoso Test Labs Pty Ltd

IT Environment Overview and Migration Plan

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Company background

Contoso Test Labs is a small software testing and quality assurance company based in Newcastle, New South Wales. The company employs 35 staff and runs automated test pipelines for clients in the finance and retail sectors.

Current environment

The company's operating system of choice has been Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL). Ten RHEL servers run the internal test runners, build agents, and reporting services. Container workloads run on Red Hat OpenShift, and server configuration is managed with Red Hat Ansible Automation Platform.

The company's cloud platform of choice has been Amazon Web Services (AWS). Workloads include Amazon EC2 instances for build agents, Amazon S3 for test artifacts and logs, Amazon RDS for PostgreSQL for the reporting database, AWS Lambda for scheduled jobs, and Amazon CloudFront for serving test reports to clients.

Planned changes

Contoso Test Labs is migrating its operating system from Red Hat Enterprise Linux to Arch Linux. The main reasons are reducing subscription costs and giving engineers access to the latest packages and kernels for testing against current software. The team accepts the trade-off of a rolling release model and will pin package versions and stage updates through a test server before rolling them out.

Contoso Test Labs is also migrating its cloud platform from AWS to Microsoft Azure. The main reasons are consolidating with the company's existing Microsoft 365 licensing, using Azure OpenAI for a new AI-assisted test analysis product, and using Azure Cosmos DB for storing test results.

Area	Current (before migration)	Target (after migration)
Operating system	Red Hat Enterprise Linux	Arch Linux
Configuration mgmt	Ansible Automation Platform	Ansible (open source)
Containers	Red Hat OpenShift	Azure Kubernetes Service
Cloud platform	Amazon Web Services	Microsoft Azure
Compute	Amazon EC2	Azure Virtual Machines
Object storage	Amazon S3	Azure Blob Storage
Database	Amazon RDS for PostgreSQL	Azure Cosmos DB
Scheduled jobs	AWS Lambda	Azure Functions

Migration timeline

Phase 1 (October to November 2026): Build an Arch Linux base image and run it alongside RHEL on two non-critical build agents. Begin moving test artifacts from Amazon S3 to Azure Blob Storage.

Phase 2 (December 2026 to February 2027): Move build agents and test runners to Azure Virtual Machines running Arch Linux. Migrate the reporting database to Azure Cosmos DB.

Phase 3 (March 2027): Decommission remaining RHEL servers, cancel Red Hat subscriptions, and close the AWS account once all data has been verified on Azure.

Risks and notes

Arch Linux has no commercial support, so the team will rely on internal expertise and the Arch Wiki. During the migration the company will pay for both AWS and Azure, so cloud costs are expected to rise temporarily before falling after Phase 3.

Fictitious company document generated for software testing purposes.